



The Length of a Sheber by Mr. Morris Arking

According to the custom of Aleppo, when blowing the Shebarim, each Sheber should be a short sound (less than three beats of a Teru'ah). This is unlike the custom of both the Jews of Damascus and of the Ashkenazim that blow a longer sound for each Sheber. It is also unlike the opinion of many Aharonim that require at least three Teru'ah beats (Terumetin) for each Sheber. The reason for this requirement is because at least three Shebarim are blown, and between the three Shebarim, nine Terumetin are required. However in Aleppo five Shebarim were blown and therefore they fulfilled the requirement of nine Terumetin with five shorter Shebarim.

This custom is documented in the book Yishaq Yeranen, which is a collection of letters written to and from Hakham Yishaq Shehebar A"H, the former Chief Rabbi of Argentina. On this topic he corresponded with his teacher Hakham Mose' Tawil A"H the former Chief Rabbi of Aleppo. The reason for this custom is to fulfill the Misvah also according to the first Yesh Omrim in Shulhan 'Arukh O"H 590:3, which is the opinion of Rashi. According to Rashi the minimum length of a Teru'ah/Teqi'ah is three Terumetin. We follow the opinion of the Rashba that the minimum length of a Teru'ah/Teqi'ah is nine Terumetin (the second Yesh Omrim in Shulhan 'Arukh). However if we blow the Shebarim according to the second opinion then each Sheber would be three Terumetin, which according to Rashi would be three Teqi'ot (not one set of Shebarim). So in order to fulfill the Misvah according to both opinions that are quoted in Shulhan 'Arukh (Rashi and Rashba), we blow each Teqi'ah/Teru'ah a minimum of nine Terumetin (the Teqi'ot for TaShRaT are 18 Terumetin), but each Sheber less than three Terumetin, and fulfill the requirement of nine Terumetin (the second Yesh Omrim) by blowing five Shebarim. This is based on Maran's comment in the Bet Yosef (in that same Siman) of "V'Ha'Olam Lo Nahagu Ken, Ella M'Qass'rim HaSheber Kol Mah She-Efshar".